Einbürgerungstest Berlin

1. Grundrechte (Fundamental rights)

- **Meinungsfreiheit** (freedom of expression) - you may openly criticise die Regierung (the government). You may express your opinion online.
- Meinungsfreiheit (freedom of expression) is restricted in cases of **öffentliche Verbreitung falscher Behauptungen** (public dissemination of false claims) about specific people.
- **Pressefreiheit** (freedom of the press) is a Grundrecht (fundamental right); a Partei (political party) cannot abolish it.
- **Pressezensur** (press censorship) is NOT a feature of Demokratie (democracy).
- **Religionsfreiheit** (freedom of religion) - until a child is **14 years old**, Eltern (parents) decide whether the child attends **Religionsunterricht** (religious education classes).
- **Glaubens- und Gewissensfreiheit** (freedom of faith and conscience) is a fundamental right.
- **Freizügigkeit** (freedom of movement) - you may choose your own Wohnort (place of residence).
- **Recht auf Asyl** (right to asylum) is the only Grundrecht (fundamental right) that applies **only to Ausländer** (foreign nationals).
- **Artikel 1 GG** (Article 1 of the Basic Law) guarantees the **Unantastbarkeit der Menschenwürde** (inviolability of human dignity).
- **Grundgesetz** (Basic Law) is the name of Germany's Verfassung (constitution).
- **Zwangsarbeit** (forced labour) is prohibited by the Grundgesetz (Basic Law).
- A **Geldstrafe** (fine) is compatible with the Grundgesetz (Basic Law).
- NOT in the Grundgesetz (Basic Law): "alle sollen gleich viel Geld haben" (everyone should have the same amount of money).
- The state prohibits **Ungleichbehandlung** (unequal treatment) of Bürger (citizens).
- **Briefgeheimnis** (privacy of correspondence) - you must not open other people's Briefe (letters).
- A Partei (political party) seeking a Diktatur (dictatorship) is **verfassungswidrig** (unconstitutional).
- A Partei (political party) may be verboten (banned) if it **gegen die Verfassung kämpft** (fights against the constitution).

2. Staatsaufbau (Structure of the state)

- Germany is a **Republik** (republic), a **demokratischer und sozialer Bundesstaat** (democratic and social federal state). It is NOT a Monarchie (monarchy).
- Full name: **Bundesrepublik Deutschland** (Federal Republic of Germany).
- Einwohner (population): **84 Millionen** (84 million).
- **16 Bundesländer** (16 federal states). **Elsass-Lothringen** (Alsace-Lorraine) is NOT a federal state.
- Structure: **Bund** (federation) → **Länder** (federal states) → **Kommunen** (local authorities). The lowest level is the **Gemeinden** (municipalities).
- Each federal state has its **eigene Regierung** (own government). Its head is the **Ministerpräsident/in** (state premier).
- **Schulpolitik** (school policy) is the responsibility of the Länder (federal states), not the federation.

• Staat (the state) and Religionsgemeinschaften (religious communities) are **getrennt** (separate).

Parlament und Regierung (Parliament and government):

• Parliament = **Bundestag** (Federal Parliament). Abgeordnete (members of parliament) are elected by the Volk (people).

• **Bundestag** (Federal Parliament) + **Bundesrat** (Federal Council) = **Legislative** (legislature).

• **Bundesrat** (Federal Council) = Regierungsvertreter der Länder (representatives of the federal state governments). Through it, the federal states participate in **Gesetzgebung** (legislation).

• The **Bundeskanzler/in** (Federal Chancellor) leads the Kabinett (cabinet) and is elected by the **Bundestag** (Federal Parliament).

• The **Bundespräsident/in** (Federal President) is the Staatsoberhaupt (head of state) and repräsentiert das Land (represents the country). The president is elected by the **Bundesversammlung** (Federal Convention). Citizens **cannot elect the president directly** (nicht direkt wählen).

• The president proposes a candidate for chancellor and **ernennt die Minister** (appoints the ministers).

• **Opposition** (opposition) = members of parliament who do not belong to the governing coalition. Its task: **die Regierung kontrollieren** (scrutinise the government).

• **Fraktion** (parliamentary group) = a group of members of the same political party in parliament.

• **Koalition** (coalition) = cooperation between parties for Regierungsbildung (forming a government).

• A **Bürgerversammlung** (citizens' assembly) is NOT a Verfassungsorgan (constitutional body).

• The **Presse** (press) is NOT a staatliche Gewalt (branch of state power).

• The president of the Bundestag (Federal Parliament) is a member of the **stärkste Fraktion** (largest parliamentary group).

• The **Bundeskanzleramt** (Federal Chancellery) and the Bundestag (Federal Parliament) are in **Berlin**.

Aktuelle Personen (Current officeholders):

• Kanzler (Chancellor): **Friedrich Merz**.

• Präsident (President): **Frank-Walter Steinmeier**.

• Largest Fraktionen (parliamentary groups): **CDU/CSU** and **AfD**.

Parteien (Political parties):

• CDU = **Christlich Demokratische Union** (Christian Democratic Union).

• CSU = **Christlich-Soziale Union** (Christian Social Union).

• SPD = **Sozialdemokratische Partei Deutschlands** (Social Democratic Party of Germany).

• FDP = **Freie Demokratische Partei** (Free Democratic Party).

• **Ampelkoalition** (traffic light coalition) = SPD + FDP + Bündnis 90/Die Grünen (Alliance 90/The Greens).

Sonstiges (Other facts):

• **Bundeswehr** (German armed forces) = deutsche Armee (German army).

• **Soziale Marktwirtschaft** (social market economy) = Angebot und Nachfrage (supply and demand) + sozialer Ausgleich (social balance).

• More **Zweitstimmen** (second votes) for a party = more Sitze (seats) in parliament.

• Most working people are **bei einer Firma oder Behörde beschäftigt** (employed by a company or a public authority).

• **Bundesverdienstkreuz** (Federal Cross of Merit) is a state Ehrung (honour).

• The **Ordnungsamt** (public order office) is part of the **Gemeindeverwaltung** (municipal administration).

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3. Wahlen und Beteiligung (Elections and participation)

• The Bundestag (Federal Parliament) is elected **alle 4 Jahre** (every 4 years).
• You may wählen (vote) from the age of **18** if you are a Staatsbürger (citizen).
• Voting is **ein Recht** (a right), not a Pflicht (duty).
• Electoral principles: **frei, gleich, geheim** (free, equal, secret).
• Nobody may zwingen (force) you to vote or beeinflussen (influence) your vote.
• **Aktives Wahlrecht** (right to vote) = the right to wählen (vote). **Passives Wahlrecht** (right to stand for election) = the right to be elected.
• **5%-Hürde** (5% threshold) - a party needs at least 5% of the Zweitstimmen (second votes) to enter Parlament (parliament). It prevents numerous small Parteien (parties) from making Regierungsbildung (forming a government) difficult.
• System: **Mehrheits- und Verhältniswahlrecht** (a combination of majority voting and proportional representation).
• The party with the **meisten Stimmen** (most votes) wins.
• **Briefwahl** (postal voting) is erlaubt (permitted).
• Before an election, the Gemeinde (municipality) sends a **Wahlbenachrichtigung** (polling notification).
• **Abgeordnete** (members of parliament) = vom Volk gewählt (elected by the people).
• **Volkssouveränität** (popular sovereignty) = Staatsgewalt geht vom Volke aus (state power derives from the people).
• Regular elections make a **Regierungswechsel** (change of government) possible.
• Several parties are needed to **unterschiedliche Meinungen vertreten** (represent different opinions).
• A **Bürgerinitiative** (citizens' initiative) is a form of political Beteiligung (participation).
• **Wahlhelfer/in** (election assistant) = an **Ehrenamt** (unpaid civic role). After the election, their task is Stimmen zählen (counting votes).
• **Bürgermeister/in** (mayor) = Oberhaupt einer Gemeinde (head of a municipality).
• **Ehrenamt** (voluntary service) = freiwillige und unbezahlte Arbeit (voluntary, unpaid work) in Vereinen (associations).
• **Landtagswahl** (state parliamentary election) = election of a federal state's parliament.

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4. Rechtsstaat und Gerichte (Rule of law and courts)

• **Rechtsstaat** (state governed by the rule of law) = everyone, both Bürger (citizens) and Staat (the state), **müssen sich an die Gesetze halten** (must obey the laws).
• Three Gewalten (branches of power): **Legislative** (legislature), **Exekutive** (executive), **Judikative** (judiciary).
• **Gerichte** (courts) do NOT belong to the Exekutive (executive); they are part of the **Judikative** (judiciary).
• **Presse** (press) and **Direktive** (directive) are NOT a staatliche Gewalt (branch of state power).
• The **Bundesverfassungsgericht** (Federal Constitutional Court) interprets the Grundgesetz (Basic Law).

- A **Richter/in** (judge) belongs to the **Judikative** (judiciary), also called rechtsprechende Gewalt (judicial power). A judge spricht Urteile (delivers judgments).
- A **Rechtsanwalt/Rechtsanwältin** (lawyer) berät (advises) and vertritt vor Gericht (represents clients in court).
- **Schöffe/Schöffin** (lay judge) = **ehrenamtlicher Richter** (volunteer judge). Together with the professional judge, a lay judge decides on Schuld und Strafe (guilt and punishment).
- **Prozess** (trial) = Verfahren vor Gericht (court proceedings).
- **Arbeitsgericht** (labour court) handles employment disputes, such as ungerechtfertigte Kündigung (unjustified dismissal).
- **Kündigungsschutzklage** (action for protection against dismissal) is brought in cases of wrongful dismissal.
- The **Polizei** (police) ensure Einhaltung von Gesetzen (compliance with the law).
- Privatpolizei (private police) **cannot** verhaften (arrest) people without grounds; this contradicts the Rechtsstaat (rule of law).

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5. Soziale Sicherheit (Social security)

- **Sozialversicherung** (social insurance) is funded through **Sozialabgaben** (social security contributions).
- **Arbeitgeber** (employers) + **Arbeitnehmer** (employees) pay these contributions.
- With a feste Anstellung (permanent job), Sozialversicherung (social insurance) contributions are paid **automatisch** (automatically).
- **Krankenversicherung** (health insurance) provides soziale Sicherheit (social protection).
- **Pflegeversicherung** (long-term care insurance) is part of Sozialversicherung (social insurance).
- **Lebensversicherung** (life insurance) is NOT part of gesetzliche Sozialversicherung (statutory social insurance).
- **Gewerkschaften** (trade unions) = Interessenverbände der Arbeitnehmer (associations representing employees' interests).
- A **Betriebsrat** (works council) helps Arbeitnehmer (employees) within a Firma (company).
- **Umsatzsteuer** (value added tax, VAT) is NOT deducted from Gehalt (salary).
- **Kirchensteuer** (church tax) exists; this is why membership of a Kirche (church) is stated in the Steuererklärung (tax return).
- The **Kündigungsfrist** (notice period) must be observed when giving Kündigung (notice of termination).
- An **Einspruch** (objection) is filed against an incorrect **Steuerbescheid** (tax assessment).
- A **Widerspruch** (administrative objection) is filed against an incorrect bill from a **Behörde** (public authority).
- Poor treatment at a Behörde (public authority) → complain to the **Behördenleiter/in** (head of the authority).
- The state builds Straßen und Schulen (roads and schools), but **does NOT pay for Urlaubsreisen** (holiday trips).

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6. Geschichte: bis 1945 (History: up to 1945)

- The **Nationalsozialisten** (National Socialists, Nazis) were in power from **1933-1945**.

- Hitler became **Reichskanzler** (Reich Chancellor) in **1933**.
- The National Socialists established a **Diktatur** (dictatorship). "Drittes Reich" (Third Reich) = Diktatur (dictatorship).
- Under National Socialism, there were **no freie Wahlen** (free elections); Parteien (political parties) were verboten (banned).
- NS-Staat (Nazi state) = a policy of **staatlicher Rassismus** (state racism).
- **9. November 1938** (9 November 1938) - Kristallnacht (Night of Broken Glass): **Synagogen** (synagogues) and **jüdische Geschäfte** (Jewish shops) were destroyed.
- **Claus Schenk Graf von Stauffenberg** - Attentat auf Hitler (assassination attempt against Hitler), **20. Juli 1944** (20 July 1944).
- **Zweiter Weltkrieg** (Second World War): **1939-1945**.
- End of the war in Europe: **8. Mai 1945** (8 May 1945) - Germany's **bedingungslose Kapitulation** (unconditional surrender).

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7. Geschichte: 1945-1990 (History: 1945-1990)

Besatzung (Occupation):

- **Alliierte Besatzungsmächte** (Allied occupying powers): **USA** (United States), **Sowjetunion** (Soviet Union), **Großbritannien** (Great Britain), **Frankreich** (France). Japan was NOT an Allied power.
- **4 Besatzungszonen** (4 occupation zones): GB (Great Britain) - Nordwesten (northwest); UdSSR (Soviet Union) - Nordosten (northeast); USA (United States) - Südosten (southeast); Frankreich (France) - Südwesten (southwest).
- **Berlin** was divided into **4 Sektoren** (4 sectors).
- **Luftbrücke** (Berlin Airlift), **1948-1949**: the Sowjetunion (Soviet Union) blocked Landverkehr (land transport) to West-Berlin (West Berlin).

Zwei Staaten (Two states):

- The BRD (Federal Republic of Germany) and DDR (German Democratic Republic) were founded in **1949**.
- The DDR (German Democratic Republic) emerged in the **sowjetische Besatzungszone** (Soviet occupation zone).
- DDR = **Deutsche Demokratische Republik** (German Democratic Republic). It existed from **1949-1990**.
- First Bundeskanzler (Federal Chancellor) of the BRD (Federal Republic of Germany): **Konrad Adenauer**.
- **Wirtschaftswunder** (economic miracle) - the **1950er Jahre** (1950s).

DDR (German Democratic Republic):

- **17. Juni 1953** (17 June 1953) - **Volksaufstand** (popular uprising) in the DDR (German Democratic Republic).
- **Stasi** = **Ministerium für Staatssicherheit** (Ministry for State Security), the Geheimpolizei (secret police) of the DDR (German Democratic Republic).
- DDR (German Democratic Republic) = **Planwirtschaft** (planned economy).
- The DDR (German Democratic Republic) belonged to the **Warschauer Pakt** (Warsaw Pact).

- Flagge (flag) of the DDR (German Democratic Republic): schwarz-rot-gold (black, red and gold) + **Hammer, Zirkel, Ährenkranz** (hammer, compass and wreath of grain).
- **Eiserner Vorhang** (Iron Curtain) = Abgrenzung (separation) of the Warsaw Pact bloc from the Westen (West).

Berliner Mauer (Berlin Wall):

- Built by the **DDR** (German Democratic Republic) in **1961**.
- Berlin was durch eine Mauer geteilt (divided by a wall) from **1961-1989**.
- Mauerfall (fall of the Wall): **1989**.
- **Montagsdemonstrationen** (Monday demonstrations), 1989 - people chanted "**Wir sind das Volk**" (We are the people).
- **Die Wende** (the turning point) - autumn 1989: the transition from Diktatur (dictatorship) to Demokratie (democracy).

Ehemalige DDR-Länder (Former East German states) - remember all 5:

1. Mecklenburg-Vorpommern (Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania)
2. Brandenburg (Brandenburg)
3. Sachsen (Saxony)
4. Sachsen-Anhalt (Saxony-Anhalt)
5. Thüringen (Thuringia)

Sonstiges (Other facts):

- **Willy Brandt** - **Ostverträge** (Eastern Treaties); **Kniefall in Warschau** (kneeling in Warsaw), **1970** - he asked Poland and the Jewish people for Verzeihung (forgiveness).

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8. Wiedervereinigung (Reunification)

- **3. Oktober** (3 October) - **Tag der Deutschen Einheit** (German Unity Day).
- **5 östliche Länder** (5 eastern federal states) joined the BRD (Federal Republic of Germany).
- This is called **Deutsche Wiedervereinigung** (German reunification).
- Kanzler der Deutschen Einheit (Chancellor of German Unity): **Helmut Kohl**.
- Germany's present Grenzen (borders) date from **1990**.
- After reunification, the eastern federal states became part of the **EU** (European Union).

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9. Europa und EU (Europe and the EU)

- The BRD (Federal Republic of Germany) is a **Gründungsmitglied** (founding member) of the EU (European Union).
- EU = **Europäische Union** (European Union). It currently has **27 Mitgliedstaaten** (27 member states).
- **Römische Verträge** (Treaties of Rome) - establishment of the **EWG / Europäische Wirtschaftsgemeinschaft** (European Economic Community). Its 50th Jubiläum (anniversary) was in **2007**.
- **Europäische Integration** (European integration) = Zusammenschluss (union) of European states within the EU (European Union).

- Aim of the EU (European Union): **Frieden und Sicherheit** (peace and security).
- **Europäisches Parlament** (European Parliament) - elected every **5 Jahre** (5 years). It works in **Straßburg** (Strasbourg), **Luxemburg** (Luxembourg) and **Brüssel** (Brussels).
- **Europawahl** (European Parliament election) = election of the Abgeordnete des EP (Members of the European Parliament).
- **Schengener Abkommen** (Schengen Agreement) - travel in Europe **ohne Passkontrolle** (without passport checks).
- **Euro** (euro) cash has been in circulation, in bar (as banknotes and coins), since **2002**.
- Germany's **Nachbarländer** (neighbouring countries): Schweiz (Switzerland), Polen (Poland), Dänemark (Denmark), Luxemburg (Luxembourg), Tschechien (Czechia), Frankreich (France), Österreich (Austria), Belgien (Belgium), Niederlande (Netherlands).
- **Österreich** (Austria) is a country with a large deutschsprachige Bevölkerung (German-speaking population).

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10. Symbole, Feiertage, Kultur (Symbols, holidays, culture)

- **Flagge** (flag): **schwarz-rot-gold** (black, red and gold).
- **Wappentier** (heraldic animal): **Adler** (eagle). The **Bundesadler** (federal eagle) hangs in the Plenarsaal (plenary chamber) of the Bundestag (Federal Parliament).
- The **Nationalhymne** (national anthem) begins: "**Einigkeit und Recht und Freiheit**" (Unity and justice and freedom).
- **Rosenmontag** (Rose Monday) - Karneval (carnival): Kostüme und Masken (costumes and masks).
- **Weihnachten** (Christmas) - **Tannenbaum schmücken** (decorate a Christmas tree).
- **Adventszeit** (Advent) - 4 Wochen vor Weihnachten (4 weeks before Christmas).
- **Ostern** (Easter) - **Eier bemalen** (paint eggs).
- **Pfingsten** (Pentecost) is a christlicher Feiertag (Christian holiday).
- **Christentum** (Christianity) has shaped europäische und deutsche Kultur (European and German culture).
- **Religiöse Toleranz** (religious tolerance) = jeder kann glauben, was er möchte (everyone may believe what they wish).
- **27. Januar** (27 January) - **Gedenktag** (remembrance day) for Opfer des Nationalsozialismus (victims of National Socialism). Befreiung von Auschwitz (liberation of Auschwitz).

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11. Bildung, Familie, Alltag (Education, family, everyday life)

Bildung (Education):

- **Schulpflicht** (compulsory schooling) applies to all Kinder (children). The state supervises schools because this is laid down in the Grundgesetz (Basic Law).
- **Anwesenheitspflicht** (compulsory attendance) - a child must be present at Schule (school).
- **Abitur** (university entrance qualification) is needed to enter a **Universität** (university). Adults can obtain it at an **Abendgymnasium** (evening secondary school).
- **Kindergartenplatz** (kindergarten place) - a right from the age of **3** until school starts. **Eltern** (parents) decide whether their child attends Kindergarten (kindergarten).

- **VHS / Volkshochschule** (adult education centre) = an institution for **Weiterbildung** (continuing education).
- **BIZ / Berufsinformationszentrum** (careers information centre) helps people find a **Lehrstelle** (apprenticeship place).
- Best chances of finding an Arbeitsplatz (job) = being **gut ausgebildet** (well trained).
- Erwachsene (adults) should continue learning after their Ausbildung (training).

Familie und Kinder (Family and children):

- **Kindererziehung** (raising children) is the responsibility of **Eltern** (parents).
- **Kinder schlagen** (hitting children) is **strafbar** (a punishable offence).
- The **Jugendamt** (youth welfare office) helps with Erziehungsprobleme (parenting problems). It can remove a Kind (child) from a Familie (family).
- **Elterngeld** (parental allowance) requires an **Antrag** (application) to the **Elterngeldstelle** (parental allowance office).
- **Mutterschutz** (maternity protection) provides legal protection for Schwangere (pregnant women).
- Dismissal because of Schwangerschaft (pregnancy) is **verboten** (prohibited).
- **Strafmündig** (criminally responsible) from the age of **14**.

Ehe und Alter (Marriage and age):

- **Volljährig** (legally an adult) from the age of **18** - you make your own Entscheidungen (decisions).
- You may be in an **Ehe** (marriage) with only **einem Partner** (one partner) at a time.
- Anne (13) and Tim (25) may NOT zusammenleben (live together).
- For a Heirat (marriage), first go to the **Standesamt** (civil registry office).
- **Trennungsjahr** (year of separation) - at least 1 year before **Scheidung** (divorce). An **Anwalt/Anwältin** (lawyer) is required.

Alltag (Everyday life):

- After an Umzug (move), register with the **Einwohnermeldeamt** (residents' registration office).
- **Nachtruhe** (night-time quiet hours) begins at **22 Uhr** (22:00).
- A **Demonstration** (demonstration) must be **angemeldet** (registered in advance).
- To open a restaurant, you need a **Gaststättenerlaubnis** (restaurant licence).
- Führerschein (driving licence): the Theorieprüfung (theory test) can be taken **in einer anderen Sprache** (in another language; more than 10 languages are available).
- **Hausordnung** (house rules) = Regeln (rules) for all Bewohner (residents).
- **Gleichbehandlung** (equal treatment) - you must not benachteiligen (discriminate against) people because of Behinderung (disability), Hautfarbe (skin colour) or Mutterschaft (motherhood).
- Faulty goods → **reklamieren** (make a complaint to the seller or return the goods).

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12. Jüdisches Leben und Antisemitismus (Jewish life and antisemitism)

- **Jüdische Gemeinden** (Jewish communities) have existed in Germany for around **1,700 years**.
- The largest jüdische Gemeinden (Jewish communities) are in **Berlin** and **München** (Munich).

- **Synagoge** (synagogue) = jüdisches Gotteshaus (Jewish house of worship).
- **Makkabi-Sportvereine** (Makkabi sports clubs; around 40 in Germany) - **jeder Mensch** (anyone) can become a member.
- Holocaust (Holocaust) denial = up to **5 years of Freiheitsstrafe** (imprisonment) or a Geldstrafe (fine). It is an example of **antisemitisches Verhalten** (antisemitic behaviour).
- **Öffentlicher Aufruf zur Vernichtung Israels** (public call for the destruction of Israel) is verboten (prohibited).
- **Stolpersteine** (stumbling stones) commemorate the **Opfer des Nationalsozialismus** (victims of National Socialism).
- Staat Israel (the State of Israel) was founded on the basis of a **UN-Resolution** (United Nations resolution).
- Germany has a besondere Verantwortung (special responsibility) towards Israel because of **NS-Verbrechen gegen Juden** (Nazi crimes against Jews).

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13. Migration (Migration)

- The largest group of Migranten (migrants) to Germany comes from **Türkei** (Turkey).
- The first **Gastarbeiter** (guest workers), in the 1950s and 1960s, came from **Italien** (Italy).
- Migrants in the DDR (German Democratic Republic) came from **Vietnam** (Vietnam), **Polen** (Poland) and **Mosambik** (Mozambique).

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14. Berlin (Berlin)

10 questions.

- Berlin's **Wappen** (coat of arms): a **Bär** (bear).
- **Bezirk** (borough): **Pankow** is a borough of Berlin.
- The **Landesparlament** (state parliament) is elected for **5 Jahre** (5 years).
- In Berlin, you may vote in **Kommunalwahlen** (local elections) from the age of **16**.
- **Landesflagge** (state flag): **weiß-rot** (white and red).
- Political information: **Landeszentrale für politische Bildung** (State Agency for Civic Education).
- Berlin is a **Stadtstaat** (city-state).
- Head of Berlin: **Regierender Bürgermeister / Regierende Bürgermeisterin** (Governing Mayor).
- Berlin has NO **Senator/in für Außenbeziehungen** (senator for foreign relations); this is a federal responsibility.